



OPERATIONAL MEMO

Title: 2026 Increase to Income Limits-Medicare Savings Programs and Low-Income Subsidy	Topic: Eligibility Policy
Audience: County Departments of Human/Social Services, Medical Assistance (MA) Sites and Eligibility Application Partner (EAP) Sites	Sub-Topic: Income & Resource Eligibility
Supersedes Number: HCPF OM 25-013	Division: Eligibility Policy
Effective Date: April 01, 2026	Office: Medicaid Operations Office
Expiration Date: April 01, 2028	Program Area: Eligibility
Key Words: 2026, FPL, Increase, Income Limits, Medicare Savings Programs, Qualified Medicare Beneficiaries, Specified Low-Income Beneficiaries, Qualified Individuals-1, Qualified Disabled and Working Individuals, Low Income Subsidy	
Legal Authority: CMCS Informational Bulletin - January 23, 2026	
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Operational Memo Number: HCPF OM 26-025	
Issue Date: April 8, 2026	
Approved By: Marivel Klueckman	

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Purpose and Audience:

The purpose of this memo is to advise Eligibility Sites (county departments of human/social service), Medical Assistance (MA) Sites, and Eligibility Application Partners (EAP) (referred to in this memo as “agency” or “agencies”) of the 2026 increased income limits for Qualified Medicare Beneficiaries (QMB), Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiaries (SLMB), Qualified Individuals (QI-1), Qualified Disabled Working Individuals (QDWI) and Low-Income Subsidy (LIS).

Information:

The income limits for the QMB, SLMB, QI-1, QDWI and LIS programs are based on federal poverty level (FPL) guidelines that are updated annually. The 2026 guidelines

were published on January 26, 2026 (Federal Register, Vol 91, No. 16, pages 3066-3077).

The MSP income limits listed below include the \$20 unearned income disregard. The QDWI program does not include the earned income disregard, as this is already programmed in CBMS when earned income is entered.

		2025	2026
QMB 100% FPL	Individual	\$1,325	\$1,350
	Couple	\$1,783	\$1,824
QI-1 135% FPL	Individual	\$1,781	\$1,816
	Couple	\$2,400	\$2,455
SLMB 120% FPL	Individual	\$1,585	\$1,616
	Couple	\$2,135	\$2,184
QDWI 200% FPL	Individual	\$2,609	\$2,660
	Couple	\$3,525	\$3,607
LIS 150% FPL	Individual	\$1,977	\$2,015
	Couple	\$2,664	\$2,725

Action To Be Taken:

Effective April 1, 2026, the Colorado Benefits Management System (CBMS) will be updated to reflect the new income guidelines for Medicare Savings Programs.

Eligibility Sites must refer to these updated income guidelines as of April 1st when making an eligibility determination.

Attachment(s):

None

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